Alder is the lowest-upfront-cost option that meets the 200 km minimum range

Procurement requires at least 200 km of range. Three of the four options meet it. Cedar, at 190 km, does not, even though its upfront cost is the lowest of the four.

Four shuttle options compared on the same criteria. Range in kilometres (km); costs in thousands of US dollars (USD thousands). Fictional planning estimates.

Criterion	**Alder** Answer: lowest upfront cost meeting range	Birch	Cedar	Dogwood
Range (km)	**210**	240	190	220
Meets 200 km minimum range	**Yes**	Yes	**No (10 km short)**	Yes
Upfront cost (USD thousands)	**38**	44	35	47
Lowest upfront cost among options meeting range	**Yes**	No	Not eligible	No
Estimated annual energy cost (USD thousands)*	**4.2**	3.9	4.5	3.8

- *Annual energy estimates assume 18,000 km of service per vehicle and exclude maintenance and charging-infrastructure costs.
- Upfront cost and annual energy cost are shown separately; they are not combined. Alder is lowest only on upfront cost among qualifying options.
- Fictional scenario. All figures are estimates from one procurement worksheet; no uncertainty ranges were provided.